

Wanting Echo Zhao

Malaysia / China | echozhao1998@gmail.com | +60 17 659 8207 | Deaf

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Summary

Deaf data science and design professional with experience spanning research, business operations, accessibility initiatives, and visual strategy across technology and academic environments. Skilled at translating complex information into actionable insights through data analysis, user research, and clear narrative communication. Currently pursuing a Master of Data Science at Monash University Malaysia with a strong interest in inclusive systems, organizational research, and human-centered technology.

Work Experience

Woman Alliance Group — Research & Strategy Intern

Jan 2026 – Apr 2026

- Co-authored and supported editorial development of *Symbiotic Workplace: 2026 China Inclusive Workplace Exemplary Case White Paper*, covering 20 companies across six domains: inclusive culture, gender equality, intergenerational integration, disability inclusion, employee well-being, and CSR.
- Designed and structured a new product framework, including a Figma-based promotion handbook, improving the clarity, usability, and consistency of internal knowledge assets.
- Conducted research on ESG and ERG topics, synthesizing findings into structured outputs including reports, presentation decks, and web content.

Clearwater — Research & Strategy Intern

Jul 2025

- Led research on DEI visibility, gender equity practices, and employer branding strategies across 18 global competitors (Big Four, mid-tier, boutique).
- Evaluated certification pathways (IIP, Good Work Standard, Best Companies) and produced actionable recommendations for improving external DEI storytelling.
- Authored a 30-page research handbook and delivered a 30-minute executive presentation outlining strategic recommendations for inclusive employer branding.
- Synthesized qualitative and quantitative insights into a structured framework usable by HR, People & Culture, and leadership teams.

China Education Symposium at Harvard University — Design Director

Nov 2024 – Nov 2025

- Directed design strategy for a global education symposium, creating inclusive visual content and communication materials for diverse audiences.
- Led cross-cultural design teams to produce inclusive, accessible digital and print materials.
- Developed storytelling-based presentations and handbooks, integrating user-centered design principles to enhance audience engagement.
- Collaborated with speakers, researchers, and organizers to ensure clarity, accessibility, and consistency across all outputs.

Apple Inc. — Operations Specialist | Business Expert | Specialist

Shenzhen, China · Oct 2021 – Apr 2024

Operations Specialist - Led cross-functional operations projects to improve operational efficiency and business process integration across retail and back-office teams. - Supported data-driven decision-making by collecting, analyzing, and reporting operational metrics to drive actionable insights. - Coordinated high-stakes business deliveries, including a 22-device launch-day fulfillment praised for accuracy and speed.

Business Expert - Drove ¥420,653 in revenue through strategic customer engagement and data-driven communication. - Conducted a rapid audit of 428 retail businesses, identifying new business opportunities and supporting market expansion. - Organized a month-long business development initiative for 150 staff, increasing qualified leads by 30%.

Specialist - Delivered patient, accessible product guidance for diverse customers, contributing to high CSAT scores. - Supported newcomer onboarding and modeled customer-centric communication.

Diversity & Accessibility (DNA) Ambassador — Volunteer - Co-led Diversity & Accessibility sessions for regional teams, promoting inclusive customer experiences. - Educated staff on communication strategies for Deaf and diverse customers, strengthening service confidence. - Contributed to internal initiatives fostering belonging, empathy, and accessibility awareness.

Education

Master of Data Science — Monash University Malaysia

Expected Graduation: October 2027

Bachelor in Statistics — Huaqiao University, China

Sep 2016 – Jul 2021

Projects

MediPort — UX Case Study: Patient-Led Care for NF2 (Rare Disease) · Jun 2026 – present, design phase ships Aug 2026 - Leading end-to-end UX research and design for a medical-record timeline tool that generates doctor-ready visit summaries for NF2 patients and caregivers. - Completed the research phase, including a bilingual (Chinese/English) survey (n=38), four in-depth patient and caregiver interviews, persona development, and problem definition. Identified caregiver “proxy distance” as the primary axis of patient needs and communication during specialist consultations as a critical yet overlooked accessibility challenge. - Collaborating with the team using Figma, FigJam, and Canva.

Personal Website & Digital Tools - Designed and developed a personal website to showcase analytical writing, research interests, and professional work. - Built web-based tools, including an image utility and an ASL fingerspelling learning prototype, to explore usability, rapid prototyping, and accessibility.

Analytical Writing & Research (Medium & Independent Work) - Published essays and analysis on technology, organizations, accessibility, and personal reflection, emphasizing structured thinking and narrative clarity.

Skills

- Data Analysis & Visualization (R, SQL, Tableau, Excel, Python (continuing to develop through MDS coursework))
- AI-Assisted Workflows (advanced use of AI tools for research, analysis, and drafting)
- Research & Analytical Writing
- Project & Stakeholder Coordination

- Digital Design & Storytelling
- Accessibility & Inclusive Design
- Cross-cultural Communication

Languages

- Chinese (Native)
- English (Professional Working Proficiency) — TOEFL Reading 27, Writing 24 (Listening and Speaking waived under ETS accommodations for deaf test-takers)
- ASL/CSL/BIM (Basic Communication)

Additional Information

I am deaf and communicate fluently in both Chinese and English through writing. Although my pronunciation may occasionally be unclear due to my medical condition, I have consistently worked effectively in multilingual, collaborative environments using text-based communication, shared documents, and data-driven workflows. I appreciate communication accommodations when appropriate. My lived experience also provides a unique perspective on accessibility, interaction design, and user experience, enabling me to identify usability barriers that are often overlooked. As I am currently studying and living in Malaysia, I am committed to building my career in Southeast Asia and am happy to discuss communication approaches that have proven effective in my previous roles.